

BUILD THE BEDROCK OF YOUR PARTNERSHIP

A strong financial foundation is the first step to building your family dynasty. So how do you construct one? We've talked about the big-picture items—financial independence, joint ownership of assets, putting the family home into a trust. But how about the day-to-day? How do you and your partner shore up the bedrock of your partnership so that you can live the kind of life you want to live? The answer is easy: you plan for it.

I once worked as a bricklayer—I'll tell you all about it in [chapter 8](#)—so I know a thing or two about building a structure that's made to last. Before you start laying bricks, you measure. You use a tape measure to determine the length and width of the wall, and then you stake out the size of it. You check and double-check your numbers, and when you're absolutely sure you've got it right, you stretch a string around the perimeter of the stakes so that you can dig out the area. All of this happens before you ever lay the first brick.

Your partnership requires the same level of diligence. In fact, you must be even *more* diligent, because you aren't just building a wall, you're building an entire life. Setting financial goals, making a plan